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The Corridor Report

Jebel Ali Racecourse · The last empty 5 km² in established Dubai
& Lulu Island · The capital's 40-year sleeping giant

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August 2026 · Prices indicative unless marked as transacted · Prepared as market intelligence, not financial advice

What's Coming

A 5 square kilometre masterplan by **A.R.M. Holding**, designed by **BIG - Bjarke Ingels Group**, announced May 2025 at a signing ceremony with A.R.M.'s CEO and Bjarke Ingels himself. Ground-break: **early 2026**. This is the transformation of the historic racecourse site into a new urban district aligned to the Dubai 2040 plan.

5 km²	8	~$5B	2026
MASTERPLAN AREA	WALKABLE NEIGHBOURHOODS	REPORTED PROJECT VALUE	GROUND-BREAK

The design thesis

"Urban islands in a sea of green" - eight mixed-use neighbourhoods densifying toward a vast central park that preserves the spatial memory of the original racetrack. A 10-minute city: schools, shops, transport, healthcare within a short walk. Microclimate engineering targets streets meaningfully cooler than the surrounding city. Equestrian heritage retained in the fabric.

Why the location is the whole story

This is **not** the Jebel Ali port corridor - despite the name, the site sits in **Al Thanyah Second: boxed by Barsha Heights and The Greens to the north, Emirates Hills and Hattan directly across First Al Khail Road, the Meadows and Springs to the southwest, Al Barsha and Arjan to the east.** It is the last empty 5 km² surrounded on every side by established, mature, fully-priced Dubai - not a frontier bet that needs the city to come to it. The city is already there, on all four fences.

Phasing - the window that matters

Delivery is phased: infrastructure and the central park first, then the **first residential neighbourhoods with early launches**. That first-phase launch is the entry event - historically, phase-one buyers in park-led masterplans capture the widest gap between launch pricing and the established ladder around them.

The Price Ladder Around the Fence

The site is ringed by everything from ~Đ900/sqft apartments to Đ4,000+/sqft super-prime villas - the widest price ladder around any single plot in Dubai. Where new product prices within this ladder is the investment question.

ZONE (RELATIVE TO SITE)	TIER	INDICATIVE PRICING	SOURCE
Emirates Hills (across First Al Khail)	**Super-prime villas**	**Đ4,000+/sqft, entry ~Đ40M+**	**Market indicative - DLD refresh landing**
Jumeirah Islands / Meadows (SW ring)	Established prime villas	Asks Đ10.5-20M (4-bed)	Live portal scan, Aug-26
Jumeirah Park / Springs (SW ring)	Established family villas	Asks Đ5.4-9.3M (4-bed)	Live portal scan, Aug-26
JGE 2.0 Cedarwood (new golf villas, 15 min)	New-launch benchmark	Đ2,200-3,000/sqft transacting sheet	Developer inventory, Aug-26
The Greens / Views + Barsha Heights (N fence)	Mid-market apartments	Đ1,300-1,800/sqft band	Market indicative - DLD refresh landing
Al Barsha South / Arjan / JVC (E + SE)	Affordable apartments	Đ900-1,300/sqft band	Market indicative - DLD refresh landing
Dubai citywide reference	All ready homes	Đ1,691/sqft avg transacted (+5.6% y/y)	ValuStrat Q1-26, published

Rows marked "DLD refresh landing" are being replaced with transacted Dubai Land Department medians from a 6-month, 106,000-transaction pull completing today - the refreshed ladder follows this report within 24 hours.

The asking-side reality check

A live scan of 4-bed family villas within a **15-minute drive** of the site (790 active listings, Aug 2026): Springs asks **Đ5.4-7.8M** · Jumeirah Park **Đ8.1-9.3M** · Meadows **Đ10.5-15M** · Arabian Ranches **~Đ11M** · Jumeirah Islands **~Đ20M**. The newest established villa community in this ring is roughly twenty years old. Family demand at Đ8-15M is being served almost entirely by twenty-year-old stock - a brand-new, BIG-designed, park-led district lands directly into that demand pool.

The thesis

A park-led premium district does not price at the Barsha end of its ladder. Design pedigree (BIG), green density, and the Emirates Hills adjacency position first-phase product toward the **upper-middle of the ring** - while launch pricing, by definition, opens below where the finished product settles. The gap between those two numbers is the phase-one buyer's margin.

How To Play It

What it costs today

Nothing. No product is on sale. The play at this stage is positioning: be registered, be documented, be first in the room when phase one opens - launch allocation goes to the prepared, not the richest.

The positioning checklist

- **Registration:** interest registered with A.R.M. channels the moment they open - Calum monitors and registers on your instruction.
- **Capital mapping:** your Income Plan already sequences your UK capital; a phase-one entry here would be weighed against the next planned rung, not added blindly on top.
- **Trigger watch (Calum monitors weekly):** launch registration opening · first price sheets · payment plan structure · which neighbourhood releases first (park-adjacent parcels are the prize).

The honest risks - in writing

- **Unlaunched pricing:** if A.R.M. prices phase one at the top of the ladder from day one, the margin thesis shrinks. We will know within minutes of the first price sheet.
- **Execution:** a 5 km² build takes the better part of a decade; early phases live beside construction for years.
- **Developer track record:** A.R.M. Holding is a major investment house but not a volume residential developer; delivery pace is unproven at this scale. The BIG partnership and government alignment mitigate, not eliminate, this.
- **Timing vs the September wave:** dozens of launches land across Dubai in Q4 2026 - competition for capital will be loud. Patience is a position too.

Bottom line: this is a watch-and-position play, not a buy-today play. The decision point arrives with the first price sheet - and the preparation that makes that decision fast costs nothing now.

Lulu Island - The 40-Year Sleeping Giant

4.2 km² of reclaimed island, 500 metres off the Corniche, directly facing Al Maryah's financial district - the best-located undeveloped land in the UAE. Reclaimed 1980s-1992 under Sheikh Zayed. Oscar Niemeyer drew 600+ designs for it; all rejected. Shelved in 1997. Revived by decree in 2003. In 2008, ownership passed to **Sorouh (60%) and Mubadala (40%) -** Sorouh's stake travelling to **Aldar** in the 2013 merger. Five masterplans across four decades, including SOM's 75-storey clam tower. Nothing built.

Who moves it now - the evidence, graded

CONFIRMED Eagle Hills (Mohamed Alabbar's Abu Dhabi vehicle) holds the Bvlgari Resort & Mansions Abu Dhabi - 60 rooms, 30 villas, 90 mansions on a **horseshoe-shaped private island** with views of Qasr Al Watan, the skyline and open sea. Opening 2030; construction reported starting soon.

STRONG INFERENCE Overlay that description on a map: Lulu is the horseshoe-shaped island facing the Corniche, with Qasr Al Watan at its breakwater end. No other island fits. Industry trackers already attribute Lulu to Eagle Hills, and site activity was reported in late July.

UNCONFIRMED No official source has printed "Lulu Island." Whether Eagle Hills holds the whole 4.2 km² or only the Bvlgari parcel is unknown. The whole-island masterplan developer remains unannounced - Aldar-Mubadala's island JV remains the ownership-side candidate.

Why it matters to your plan

Abu Dhabi is running **+17.8% annually** (ValuStrat, Q2 2026) with apartments outpacing villas at **+24%**, Al Reem at **+22%**, and ValuStrat's research head on record that the capital sits **earlier in its property cycle than Dubai**. A Lulu announcement - whoever wins it - would be the capital's biggest prime-waterfront event of the decade, and the ripple lands first on the facing shorelines: the Corniche, Al Maryah, and Reem. Your existing AD exposure sits in the blast radius of good news.

The play

Watch, hold, position - spend nothing. Calum monitors for the announcement (WAM, Aldar, Eagle Hills, Modon channels, weekly). If a launch comes with public sales, the same phase-one logic as the Racecourse applies - on the most valuable empty land in the country.

Sources: WAM-verified decrees, ValuStrat Q2 2026, official Bvlgari/Eagle Hills releases

SUMMARY

Actions & Watchlist

What Amer does now

ACTION	WHEN	COST
Confirm appetite: is a phase-one Racecourse entry inside the Income Plan's capital sequence, or watch-only?	This call	Đ0
Documents launch-ready (passport, proof of funds) - same pack serves any September launch	This month	Đ0
Decide trigger rules in advance: "if phase-one 1-beds open below Đ[X]/sqft, I'm in for Đ[Y]" - decided on shore, not in a showroom	Before first price sheet	Đ0

What Calum monitors (standing, weekly)

WATCH	TRIGGER
A.R.M. Holding / Racecourse channels	Registration opening · first price sheet · launch neighbourhood
Lulu Island (WAM, Aldar, Eagle Hills, Modon)	Any official development announcement - same-day call
DLD transacted prices, full comp ring	Quarterly ladder refresh lands in your inbox
September-November launch wave	Anything competing for the same capital at better terms

The one-line thesis: two of the UAE's best-located empty land parcels are about to get developers and price sheets. Preparation costs nothing; being early to either is the entire opportunity. Your capital plan already has the rungs - this report tells you when a rung might be worth swapping.